ThinkSwiss Research Scholarships 2026-2027 for Singapore and Brunei
Monday, 07 September 2026

ThinkSwiss Research Scholarships offer students from Singapore and Brunei the opportunity to undertake a research stint in a Swiss laboratory of their choosing. This provides scholars with an opportunity to experience the Swiss research ecosystem first-hand. The programme is subject-agnostic.

Eligibility Criteria

To apply for a ThinkSwiss Scholarship, you must:

- Currently be enrolled at an accredited university/institute of the listed countries.
- Be a Master's degree student or a Bachelor's degree student who has completed the 2nd year by the time the research stay in Switzerland begins.
- Provide written confirmation from a professor at a Swiss university or research institute mentioning they have accepted you for a research stay in their group/lab.

Please note that:

- Doctoral and postdoctoral candidates are **not** eligible to apply.
- We are subject-agnostic for applicants.
- Students applying to ETH Zurich must meet the prerequisites to become a "Project Mobility" student as stipulated by the university. Read more below.

Application Procedure

The application and all supporting documents must be sent ***via Email*** in ***one PDF*** by **31 January 2026, 23:59.** In order to be considered for this scholarship, each application must contain the following:

1. A cover letter (maximum of two pages; see details below for writing guidelines)
2. A CV (maximum two pages)
3. A copy of your current university transcripts (we accept photocopies of official transcripts issued to the student)
4. A letter of acceptance from the professor and/or host institution in Switzerland. Please request a confirmation letter on the university/institute letterhead from the host professor.
5. A letter of recommendation from a current professor who can attest to the applicant's abilities.
6. Send your application via Email to:
    - **Singapore@eda.admin.ch**

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Frequently Asked Questions

1) **Are citizens of the listed countries eligible to apply for the programme?**
   All enrolled students at accredited universities of the listed countries are eligible, but the ability to participate will depend on obtaining a visa, if necessary.

2) **How do I find a host institution and/or a professor in Switzerland?**
   Finding a professor in Switzerland is part of the due diligence process that the applicant must conduct on his/her own. For a comprehensive list of universities, please click on this link.

3) **How do I contact a host institute and professor?**

- Think about the field in which you wish to deepen your research and look for prospective supervising professors who work in that field.
- Write to them (on LinkedIn or via email) and enquire if they'd be interested in taking you on in their cohort. It can take several weeks to find your host professor, so we recommend starting as early as possible and writing to as many relevant professors as possible.
- Ideally, your email to them should include:
  - Details about why you would like to work with them and what about their work interests you.
  - Details about your skills and competencies that are relevant to the work in your chosen field.
  - Details about your past experiences and how they are relevant to your current research interest.
  - Details about how you plan to contribute to and elevate their research.
  - Details about why you would make a good fit.
  - Your CV and a proposal/short summary (250-300 words) of the research you would like to undertake under their supervision.
- Applicants are responsible for finding a host professor at a Swiss university as well as for clarifying the scope of a research project before submitting their applications for the ThinkSwiss Scholarships.
- If you are struggling to identify appropriate professors, reach out to faculty at the university you are currently enrolled in and enquire if they could recommend suitable professors for you. Where possible, request your faculty members to introduce you to prospective professors.

  Please refer to this video for further guidance.

4) **Are there any language requirements?**
   Foreign language skills are not required for a research stay in Switzerland, as the working language will generally be English. Knowledge of any Swiss national language would, of course, be helpful for daily life.

5) **Do I need the acceptance letter from the professor in a specific format?**
   Please request a confirmation letter on the university/institute letterhead from the host professor. Please also ask your host professor to mention the exact duration of your research stay in Switzerland on your acceptance letter. A copy of the email is not sufficient proof of acceptance.

6) **I have been accepted by two host institutions. Can I submit two applications for the scholarship?**

No, please choose the host institution that you truly wish to attend and the research topic you find most interesting. If you submit multiple applications, only the first one will be considered, and any additional submissions will not be evaluated.

7) **If I get a host letter from a professor, does it ensure my selection for the scholarship?**
Receiving an acceptance letter from the host institution professor is an application criterion, not a selection criterion.

8) **Can the scholarship also be applied to projects at public research institutions or private higher education institutions?**
The scholarship supports research at public universities and public research institutions. We do **not** support research stays at private higher education or research institutions.

9) **Can I submit more than one recommendation letter?**
No, please submit only one recommendation letter, whichever you think is the most compelling.

10) **Are past projects, CGPA or publications part of the evaluation criteria?**
Yes, the above points are part of the evaluation, and your CV and transcripts should reflect the same.

11) **My research project is longer than 3 months; will the scholarship duration be extended?**
ThinkSwiss Scholarships cover a maximum duration of three months. We cannot extend the length of scholarship support. Students are free to organise additional funding from other sources for a longer research stay.

12) **I am in my final year of studies, am I still eligible to apply for the ThinkSwiss Scholarship?**
You are eligible to apply as long as you complete your research in Switzerland by the time you graduate from your home university i.e. you must be enrolled at your home university until the completion of your research stay in Switzerland.

ThinkSwiss Regulations

Notification to awardees
All ThinkSwiss Scholarship winners will be notified by email by **26 February 2027, 21:00** and must accept this scholarship by **15 March 2027**.

Timeframe of your stay
The applicant is free to schedule research anytime between **1 April 2027 to 31 December 2027.** The start date of your research internship *cannot* be later than **1 November 2027**. Please be aware that in Switzerland, the semester break is approximately from June to mid-September and that during this time, universities are less busy.

Payment of the scholarship
Stipend of up to equivalent of CHF 3,600 (approximately SGD/BND 5,600, subject to exchange rate fluctuations) per application, designed to cover a research stay of around two months. Applications to a maximum of three months are welcome, but the additional costs for the third month must be self-financed.

Please note that this amount covers only a portion of the average student's living expenses and that you will be asked to prove sufficient financial means to the Swiss Cantonal authorities before a visa can be issued (if applicable, see information on visa below). The full amount of the scholarship money will be transferred to the recipient's bank account within 10 business days after their arrival in Switzerland.

Additional funding
Please note that research internships at Swiss host institutions are usually unpaid. Since ThinkSwiss does not cover all expenses (see above), we permit additional funding as long as the process of acquiring additional funds *does not delay* the timeframe of your stay.

Obligations as a ThinkSwiss Awardee
As a ThinkSwiss ambassador, you are not only advocating for the programme, but also for Switzerland as a premier study destination.

To help us highlight Switzerland effectively, we ask that you document your journey thoroughly. Please capture videos, pictures and written content (in order of preference) to vividly portray your experiences and insights.

Sharing this content on your social media will help us reach a broader audience and inspire others to consider Switzerland for their studies. We will provide you with some guidelines based on our needs to assist you in crafting your story and messaging.

Obtaining admission to the Host University
Please note that obtaining the scholarship does not mean that the student has acquired a specific status (all students enrolled in Swiss universities are assigned a 'status' that informs the level of access they get within the university) and that the awardees must comply with the host university's policies regarding admission. Each recipient is in charge of contacting the international office of your host university in Switzerland to finalise your registration and learn more about the specifics of your status at the host institution. Please coordinate and stay in touch with your host professor.

Key points to consider while reaching out to a host professor/supervisor:

1. **Self-Initiated Matching:** The ThinkSwiss programme uses a bottom-up approach, meaning you are responsible for identifying and approaching potential supervisors independently. The programme does not offer specific support to help you find a match.
2. **Evaluation and Endorsement:** Your potential supervisor will assess your academic qualifications and must endorse your research proposal. This endorsement is a crucial part of your application.
3. **Financial Responsibility:** As a ThinkSwiss awardee, you are financially responsible for your research stay. The host institution does not bear any financial responsibility, and you are expected to conduct your research using the ThinkSwiss scholarship stipend.
4. **Agreement and Support Letter:** You must reach an agreement with your potential supervisor. A formal letter from your supervisor stating their willingness to support your research project is mandatory. Without this letter, your application will be incomplete and rejected.
5. **Voluntary Decision:** Supervisors participate voluntarily. They are not obligated to support your application, so approach them respectfully and make a compelling case for your research proposal.
6. **Importance of Support Letter:** A well-prepared acceptance letter from your host supervisor can significantly influence the success of your scholarship application. Ensure you communicate the importance of this letter and provide any needed guidance to help them draft it effectively.

Responsibilities of the academic supervisor:
If you have found someone who has agreed to act as your supervisor, they are expected to:

- Supervise you during their research stay in Switzerland (up to 90 days).
- Integrate you into their team, ensuring you have access to necessary resources such as lab space and infrastructure.
- Support you in attaining an appropriate academic status (e.g., visiting researcher) at your institution.

Applications to ETH Zürich:
Scholars applying to ETH Zurich, kindly check the prerequisites beforehand:

- To be eligible for the ThinkSwiss Research Scholarship, applicants **must** apply to the "Project Mobility Students" programme at ETH Zurich. This involves a separate application process directly with the university, meaning you need to complete both application processes independently.
- Applications to ETH Zurich must be submitted *at least two months* before the planned start date of the project. If a visa is required, the application must be submitted *at least three months* before the desired start date. Please ensure these deadlines are taken into account when planning your project. Additionally, it is your responsibility to check and meet the visa/entry requirements for Switzerland.
- Kindly note that acceptance into ETH Zurich's Project Mobility Student programme does not guarantee selection as a ThinkSwiss Scholarship recipient.

Multiple applications
If you are granted a ThinkSwiss Research Scholarship, you **cannot** apply a second time. However, if your first application was not successful, you are allowed to apply again.

Writing Guidelines - Cover Letter
When writing your cover letter for the ThinkSwiss Research Scholarship, consider the following guiding questions to help you craft a strong and focused narrative. The cover letter should be a maximum of 2 pages (max. 800 words), using standard margins and a 12-point font size.

Page 1: Research Project Overview

- Briefly describe your intended research project, including its main objectives, the tasks you will undertake and the milestones you will use to measure progress.
- What new skills or knowledge do you hope to develop through this research project?
- How relevant is the proposed host institution for your research? Are there any existing collaborations with your home institution, and how will this strengthen them? If there are no current collaborations, discuss how your research could create new opportunities for collaboration.

Page 2: Personal Motivation and Qualifications

- Why do you deserve the ThinkSwiss Research Scholarship? Tell us why you're interested in your research area, how this aligns with your career goals, and how your past experiences and skills will contribute to your project's success.
- Describe a time when you faced a new challenge or unfamiliar task in your academic or research work. How did you approach it, and what did you learn? How do you plan to apply these lessons to your ThinkSwiss research project?
- Explain how you would effectively represent the ThinkSwiss programme as an ambassador.

Answering these questions thoroughly and thoughtfully will help you create a compelling cover letter that highlights both your research proposal and your personal qualifications.

General Information

If you are approved for a ThinkSwiss Scholarship, please check with the international department of the host university and inquire about registering with and accepting guidance from them in regard to student services available, housing possibilities and other amenities that may be offered by the host universities.

Visa
Applicants should verify visa requirements based on their nationality on the following website: Link. If you don't need a visa and you're not working in Switzerland (ThinkSwiss is not considered gainfull employment), you can stay for up to three months without a permit.

As of 01.09.2026: Brunei and Singapore do not need a visa.

Country	**National passports and other travel documents authorizing entry into Switzerland**	**Visa required for stays of up to 90 days[B)]**	**Visa required for stays of more than 90 days[C)]**
Brunei	see [A)]	No	No
Singapore	see [A)]	No	No

A. Third-country nationals (non EU/EFTA), regardless of their visa obligation status, wishing to enter the Schengen Area for a short-term stay (without exercising a gainful occupation) not exceeding 90 days in any 180-day period must be in possession of a recognised travel document that meets both of the following two requirements:
   - The travel document is valid for at least three months after the intended date of departure from the Schengen Area; and
   - it was issued within the last 10 years (the date of issue only concerns entry into the Schengen Area).

   The travel document's date of issue is the determining factor, regardless of any decision made by the authorities to extend the period of validity.

Housing
Students are responsible for their own housing, but a good place to start is contacting the international or housing office of the host university for recommendations.

Insurance
Please note that the scholarship does not provide health, accident or liability insurance. Applicants must make sure that they have insurance coverage for their stay in Switzerland, and it is the sole responsibility of the student to obtain this coverage.

Transportation
It is highly recommended that you use the convenient public transportation in Switzerland that takes you almost everywhere. If you plan to travel around Switzerland, it generally makes sense to buy a half-fare travel card. If you are younger than 25, you can also consider the GA travel card. Usually, you need to purchase these cards for a period of one year, but often you can resell them and get a part of your money back. Please check with a salesperson at one of the SBB counters that you can find in most of the bigger train stations in Switzerland.

Thank you for your interest in ThinkSwiss!

For questions:

Schweizerische Eidgenossenschaft
Confédération suisse
Confederazione Svizzera
Confederaziun svizra

Embassy of Switzerland in Singapore

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